



May Batch 2027

Basics of Answer Writing

Agenda for the day



1. Experiment
2. Problems in general
3. Where you will be writing
4. Importance of Answer Writing
5. Basic Structure of any Answer
6. Understanding directives
7. Body Part of the Answer
8. Implicit and Explicit Demand
9. Introduction
10. Conclusion

Experiment



Electric Mobility offers solutions to problems associated with climate change, growing fuel prices and urban transportation issues. Discuss in the context of India (250 words) (15 Marks)

Problems you faced



My mind goes blank after reading the question	I get confused about what the question is really asking	I don't know how to structure the answer
I am not sure how much to write	I repeat the same point in different words	I feel my answer looks too simple
I wrote long paragraphs	I cannot identify the main demand	I keep thinking whether UPSC is really for me
"If you are facing these problems, it means you have started the journey."		

Where you will be writing ?

Q1.

शैलकृत स्थापत्य प्रारंभिक भारतीय कला एवं इतिहास के ज्ञान के अति महत्वपूर्ण स्रोतों में से एक का प्रतिनिधित्व करता है। विवेचना कीजिए। (150 शब्दों में उत्तर दीजिए)

The rock-cut architecture represents one of the most important sources of our knowledge of early Indian art and history. Discuss.

(Answer in 150 words) 10

उम्मीदवारों को इस
कॉपी में नहीं
लिखना चाहिए।
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Importance of Answer Writing



- Answer writing is the key factor in scoring well in UPSC Mains.
 - Example: A candidate may have complete knowledge about the causes of inflation, such as demand-pull factors, cost-push factors, and monetary policy. However, if these points are written in a disorganised manner without headings or logical flow, the answer may score 4–5 marks. Another candidate with the same knowledge but a clear structure and proper sequencing may score 7–8 marks.
- UPSC evaluates clarity, relevance, and structure, not only knowledge.
 - Example: In a question on the “impact of climate change on Indian agriculture,” writing about global climate conferences or long scientific theories reduces relevance. A clear answer that directly links climate change to crop yield, rainfall patterns, and farmer income in India will score higher, even if it contains fewer facts.

Importance of Answer Writing



- Two candidates may know the same content, but the better-presented answer scores higher.
 - Example: Both candidates write about federalism. One writes in long paragraphs without headings, while the other uses headings such as “Constitutional Features” “Challenges” and “Way Forward” Even with similar content, the second answer appears more organised and is easier to evaluate, resulting in higher marks.
- Examiners check many copies in limited time, so clear answers get better attention.
 - Example: An examiner may read 100–150 answer copies in a day. An answer with short paragraphs, underlined keywords, and a visible structure helps the examiner quickly identify important points. Such answers are more likely to receive fair and higher marks than dense, cluttered answers.

Basic Structure of any Answer

- Every answer should follow Introduction–Body–Conclusion format.
 - This format gives a clear flow to the answer and helps the examiner follow the candidate's thinking easily.
 - Example: In a question on urban flooding, the introduction briefly defines urban flooding, the body explains causes and impacts, and the conclusion suggests solutions like better drainage and urban planning.
- The introduction sets context and shows understanding of the question.
 - The introduction tells the examiner that the candidate has correctly understood what the question is about. It should directly relate to the topic and not be general.
 - Example: For a question on fiscal federalism, a good introduction may define fiscal federalism in one line instead of starting with a long history of Centre–State relations.

Basic Structure of any Answer

- The body addresses the main demand in a systematic manner.
 - The body is the core of the answer and should directly respond to what the question asks. Points should be arranged logically, often using headings or clear paragraphs.
 - Example: In a question asking for challenges and solutions of electric mobility in India, the body can be divided into two parts—challenges like charging infrastructure and solutions such as government incentives.
- The conclusion completes the answer and provides closure.
 - The conclusion should neatly end the answer and often reflect a forward-looking or solution-oriented approach. It should not introduce new arguments.
 - Example: In an answer on climate change, the conclusion may emphasise sustainable development and India's role in balancing growth with environmental protection.

What is an Intro-Body-Conclusion Format

Regionalism defined as an 'Insider Outsider' thought process where loyalty one tied to the region of Origin.

Present issue of regional movement can be seen to be a consequence of rising cultural awareness,

- 1) Linguistic and Cultural Identity Movement: Many regional movements based on linguistic and cultural identity
Ex: Dravidian Movement in TN
Asserting Dravidian Culture - Maharashtra
- 2) Ethnic identity and autonomy demands: Region like North East, asserted their distinct Culture identity via autonomy and separate state. Ex: Punjab Suba Movement - Punjab
Naga and Mizo movement
- 3) Economic disparities Emphasizing Cultural Consciousness:
Separate states not only for economic disparities, but also an assertion of Cultural identity. Ex: Thakshani and chhattisgarh.

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- 1) Assertion against imposition of Uniformity: Imposition of Homogenized culture result in marginalization of region based culture. Ex: Imposition of Hindi language
- 2) Rise of political Parties: political parties often get ties with local identity to mobilize support.
Ex: Shiv Sena in Maharashtra
Telugu Desam party - Andhra Pradesh

Other factors cause for Regionalism in India

- pressure socio-economic factor.
Ex: Religions - Development and administrative factor
caste - tribal (tribe) and Religious factor
- political administrative factors.
Ex: UP division - Punjab, Haryana provinces
- Historical and Cultural ties, via Cultural Heritage, folklore, myth etc. Ex: Naga and Nagaland

In this context, along with local identity others factors also played vital role in appearance of regionalism.

Ex: Elk Bhosht Shrestha Boudh → Alakhnagar

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What is an Intro-Body-Conclusion Format

4. Analyse the need for shifting from presumptive land titling to conclusive land titling system in India. Also, highlight the hurdles in its implementation. (150 words) 10
- भारत में अनुमानित भूमि स्वामित्व से निर्णायक भूमि स्वामित्व प्रणाली में स्वातंत्र्य की आवश्यकता का विश्लेषण कीजिए। साथ ही, इसके क्रियान्वयन में आने वाली बाधाओं को रेखांकित कीजिए।

Conclusive land titling system refers to title contract between State & the landholder, rather than land records present only based on selling records, ownership, etc.

• Need for conclusive land titling :-

- ① Reduce legal disputes :- By maintaining clear land records.
- ② Quick land acquisition :- For development projects of state like bullet train, etc. reducing the cost of inflation.
- ③ Protecting landholder rights :- As state shall be responsible for providing

compensation in case of loss of land rights.

• Hurdles in implementation :-

- ① Unclear land records :- Presently, land is not clearly recorded as well as demarcated.
 - ② Family disputes :- Mostly land disputes are between families & face a huge pendency of cases in judiciary.
 - ③ Difficulty for administration :- Due to lack of training as well as manpower, this exercise shall be cumbersome to complete.
- Conclusive land titling is desired and universal digitization of land records can be the first step towards achieving it.

Understanding the Directives



- Describe
 - Present key characteristics, features and functions — focus on “How it is”.
 - Structured factual narration without opinions or judgement.
 - Example : Describe the salient features of the Indian Constitution ?

- Explain
 - Bring out reasons, factors and consequences — focus on “Why it happens”.
 - Clear cause-effect logic with conceptual clarity.
 - Example : Explain the factors responsible for the Green Revolution in India ?

Understanding the Directives

- Elaborate/Elucidate
 - Expand an idea by adding depth, linkages and details.
 - Progressive widening of the core idea, not repetition.
 - Example : Elaborate the concept of cooperative federalism in India ?

- Illustrate
 - Demonstrate understanding using examples, case studies or data.
 - Theory must be supported by concrete examples.
 - Example : Illustrate how climate change affects food security ?

Illustration : Elaborate

19. What is catalysis? Highlight the characteristics of catalysts. Also, elaborate why catalytic reactions are important for human beings. (250 words) 15
- उत्प्रेरण क्या है? उत्प्रेरकों की विशेषताओं पर प्रकाश डालिए। साथ ही, उदाहरण प्रस्तुत करते हुए समझाइए कि मानव के लिए उत्प्रेरकी अभिक्रियाएँ क्यों महत्वपूर्ण हैं।

Catalysis refers to a process that is used to control the pace of a chemical reaction i.e. to quicken it or slow it down, to achieve the desired product.

• Characteristics of catalysts :-

- ① **Neutral :-** It does not have any impact on the product i.e. maintains the composition of product.
- ② **Controls pace :-** It only affects the speed of the reaction, thus affecting the consumption of the source material.
e.g. Nuclear fusion using moderators to

reduce quick consumption of D

- ③ **Temperature :-** Catalysts depend upon temperature for the role they play in a reaction.

• Importance of catalytic reactions :-

- ① **Industry :-** Proves as an aid in commercial manufacturing of certain products.
- ② **Health :-** Carbonic acid maintains body's pH balance while digesting food.
- ③ **Medicine :-** ^{Some} Chemical reactions are not possible without catalysts as they act as a stimulus.

Understanding the Directives

- Discuss
 - Examine an issue from multiple dimensions in a balanced manner.
 - Coverage of arguments, counter-arguments and way forward.
 - Example : Discuss the role of civil society in strengthening democracy ?

- Examine
 - Investigate an issue closely by breaking it into components.
 - Analytical depth rather than surface description.
 - Example : Examine the causes of agrarian distress in India ?

Understanding the Directives

- Evaluate/Analyze
 - Judge the effectiveness or worth based on evidence.
 - Reasoned judgement supported by criteria and conclusion.
 - Example : Evaluate the performance of the National Food Security Act ?

- Critically Analyze
 - Analyze deeply by examining strengths, weaknesses and implications.
 - A balanced critique
 - Example : Critically analyze the role of media in Indian democracy ?

Understanding the Directives

- **Comment**
 - Express a brief, reasoned opinion on a given statement.
 - Interpretation of the statement followed by justification.
 - Example : “Economic growth without social justice is meaningless.” Comment ?
- **Do you agree**
 - Take a clear stand and justify it logically.
 - Explicit position supported by arguments and counter-view.
 - Example : Do you agree that judicial activism undermines parliamentary sovereignty

Illustration : Analyze

Internal Security

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12. Mob violence is emerging as a serious law and order problem in India. By giving suitable examples, 2017 analyze the cause and consequences of such violence (15) (2017)

Mob violence marked by uncontrolled public disorder and chaos. Boss mafia issue and prevalent of cow vigilantes has emerged as a different challenge to law and order.

Forms of mob violence

↓	↓	↓
Caste based communal violence	Racial based communal violence	Ethnic based communal violence

Causes of Mob violence

1. Social media manipulation → The spread of rumors and fake news through social media platforms.
 2018 - WhatsApp lynching in India, baseless rumors of child kidnapping.

2. Rozgar and caste tensions → Social prejudices and communal divisions are the cause of violent mob behaviour.
 2017 - 2018 - low vigilantes in India.

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3. Weak law enforcement → Lack of training in crowd management and poor police-chase ratio.

4. Political patronage → poor support from the local entities to control the mob violence.

5. Economic disparities → Unemployment and poverty creating the social crisis.

6. Erosion of trust in the justice system → Ineffectiveness and slow verdicts led to group based vigilantes.

Consequences of mob violence

1. Loss of life and property → Life harms and destruction of public and private property.

2. Social trauma → Creation of fear among the vulnerable community.

3. Breakdown of law → Only 15% conviction rate in mob lynching cases between 2017 - 2018.

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4. Economic disruptions → Reduced investment in the affected areas.

5. Form social divisions → ~~erect~~ establish communal divides and trust defects.

6. International Image → Negative impact on global reputation and tourism ~~also~~ sectors.

Solutions

- Create specific Anti-lynching legislation.
- Appointing Nodal officers to the district level to monitor the violence.
- Establishing fast-track courts.
- Counter the misinformation through strict social media monitoring.
- better communication between political entities and social communities.

Strict Implementation of initiatives like project MASSOON (mobile app to secure organizations and ordinary masses) demonstration that technological solutions to combat mob violence.

Body Parts of an Answer

Every UPSC question should first be broken into its constituent parts based on the directive used in the question.

Most questions contain more than one demand, either explicitly stated or implicitly embedded within the wording.

A 15-mark question generally requires addressing three to four distinct parts to justify the marks allotted.

A 10-mark question usually involves one or two core parts, requiring concise but focused treatment.

Before beginning to write the answer, the candidate should clearly identify all the parts that need to be addressed.

Body Parts of an Answer



Spending a few seconds to analyse the question helps prevent missing key dimensions in the answer.

Wherever possible, the parts should be derived directly from the language and phrases used in the question itself.

Using the terminology of the question ensures alignment with the examiner's expectations.

Each identified part should be converted into a clear and logical sub-heading in the body of the answer.

These subheadings together provide a structured framework for the body of the answer.

Body Parts of an Answer



Under each sub-heading, the candidate should present five to six relevant points to substantiate the argument.

Each point should ideally be written in one to three lines to maintain clarity and brevity.

Long paragraphs should be avoided, as they reduce readability and examiner comfort.

With practice, candidates can further sub-structure points using keywords, examples, or data.

Such sub-structuring improves analytical depth and presentation but develops gradually with experience.

Illustration : Body

2. State the need for circular economy in India and the challenges associated with it. Also, discuss the measures that are required to build a circular economy in India. (150 words) 10

भारत में चक्रीय अर्थव्यवस्था की आवश्यकता और इसके जुड़ी चुनौतियों का उल्लेख कीजिए। साथ ही, भारत में एक चक्रीय अर्थव्यवस्था के निर्माण के लिए आवश्यक उपायों पर चर्चा कीजिए।

Circular economy refers to an industrial system that focuses on restoration or regeneration in intention & design.

• Need for circular economy :-

- ① High population :- India's population of 1.3 billion people is still rising creates greater resource demand, which can be fulfilled by circular economy.
- ② Inclusive growth :- Circular economy can ensure better redistribution of wealth among people by developing multiple markets.
- ③ Employment generation :- It can open up a new sector with opportunities for traditionally

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skilled people to gain employment.

• Challenges in circular economy :-

- ① Lack of infrastructure :- Adequate processing facilities as well as technology is not available. for
- ② Public attitude :- 'Use & throw' attitude of the West has now been slightly ingrained in India. eg. A study says around 23% people change their mobiles within a year.

• Measures to build circular economy :-

- ① Incentives & 3Rs :- schemes like Deposit Refund scheme can provide help.
- ② Greater formalisation :- Formalisation of recycling sector can help in tracing & tracking waste generated. eg. Currently, only 6% formalisation. Circular economy can help in achieving SDG 6, 7 & 12 & should be worked toward.

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Illustration : Body

3. Mention various initiatives taken for online delivery of judicial services in India. Also, discuss the challenges faced in their implementation.

(150 words) 10

भारत में न्यायिक सेवाओं की ऑनलाइन प्रदायगी के लिए प्रारंभ विभिन्न पहलों का उल्लेख कीजिए। साथ ही, उनके कार्यान्वयन में आने वाली चुनौतियों पर चर्चा कीजिए।

Indian judiciary faces high pendency (~4.5 cr cases) which necessitated speedy online delivery.

Initiatives taken

- ① FASTER → for safe, secured quick transfer of bank orders from courts to person.
- ② Virtual hearings → During Covid, SC, HC & sub ordinate judiciary used video conferencing.
- ③ Upgradation of infrastructure like digital facilities, e conferencing etc. under Central Sponsored Scheme for Judicial Infrastructure.
- ④ SUPACE for document digitisation.
- ⑤ e Courts project.

Challenges faced

- ① Lack of supporting infrastructure → ~73% of courts have no video conferencing.
- ② Operational issues due to difficulty for judges to transition.
- ③ ~30% of funds under CSS for Judicial infra unutilised.
- ④ Lack of supporting ecosystem across prisons & criminal justice system.

Way forward

→ e Committee of SC recommends
→ e filing of petitions algorithm based allocation environment hybrid hearings

→ Creation of National Judicial Infrastructure Authority (NJIA)
'Ease of Justice' is the need of the hour.

Illustration : Body

3. The Major Port Authorities Act, 2021, seeks to grant greater autonomy and flexibility to the major ports and professionalise their governance. Discuss. (150 words) 10
- प्रमुख बंदरगाह प्राधिकरण अधिनियम, 2021, प्रमुख बंदरगाहों को अधिक स्वायत्तता और पेशेवरता प्रदान करने तथा उनके शासन को पेशेवर बनाने का प्रयास करता है। विवेचना कीजिए।

Major Ports Authorities Act, 2021 aims to replace Major Ports Trusts Act, 1963 applicable to 12 major Indian ports.

- Granting greater autonomy :-

① Creation of a Board :- Board of Major Port Authority shall be created for each major port, decentralising decision making.

② Authority to fix tariff :- The Board can fix the tariff for each major port.

③ Authority to use assets :- Board is free to use the assets, property & funds as they deem fit for the development of port.

- Professionalising its governance :-

① Inclusive Board :- It will have members from state government where port is located, Ministry of Railways, Defence, Customs, Central Government.

② Private participation :- Public-Private Partnership operators shall have independence to fix tariff, thus providing greater efficiency.

- Hurdles:-

↳ It may lead to graded privatisation of ports & dilution of state role in its land use.

Changing the governance structure is the first step towards improving ports & steps further should be addressing to improving service delivery & seamless connectivity.

Illustration



Question

Dairying is a viable livelihood option for a large section of population. In this context discuss the significance, challenges faced and associated government initiatives for the dairy sector in India ? (15 marks) (250 words)

Illustration : Body

13. Dairying is a viable livelihood option for a large section of the population. In this context, discuss the significance, challenges faced and associated government initiatives for the dairy sector in India. (250 words) 15

डेयरी व्यवसाय, आबादी के एक बड़े हिस्से के लिए आजीविका का एक व्यवहार्य विकल्प है। इस संदर्भ में, इसके महत्व, विद्यमान चुनौतियों और भारत में डेयरी क्षेत्र के लिए सरकार द्वारा की गयी पहलों की विवेचना कीजिए।

Dairy industry provides 30% extra income to rural households, thus improving their livelihoods by improving livelihood.

• Significance of dairy sector :-

① Largest livestock :- India is home to 530 M livestock, highest globally. (Agri Census 2015-16)

② Largest milk producer :- India is the largest producer of milk globally.

③ Employment :- It offers employment to over 16% of total population of India.

④ Diversity :- Dairy sector encompasses all cattle, along with camel, goat, etc.

• Challenges faced by dairy sector :-

① Diseases in animals :- Diseases like Foot & Mouth Disease impact the livestock & milk yield.

② Processing facilities :- The value addition through processing of milk products is not fully achieved due to lack of infrastructure.

③ Logistics :- India lacks robust 'farm-to-gate' infrastructure leading to wastage.

④ Competition globally :- Indian dairy industry faces international competition from Australia & New Zealand due to high-yielding breeds.

⑤ Product quality :- Dairy industry lacks standardization & international quality products.

making it less preferable for exports.

• Government Initiatives :-

① National Dairy Development Board :- It undertakes initiatives for greater growth of dairy sector & promotes research & development.

② Dairy Infrastructure Development Fund :- With ₹ 2000 crore fund to provide stimulus to dairy sector.

③ Karnadekhi Mission :- Focuses on research on indigenous breeds for higher yield & greater quality products.

④ Mega Food Parks :- It will integrate the processing facilities thus improving the export competitiveness of Indian dairy products.

Dairying is a survivor sector for India that can contribute to \$5 trillion economy by adequate technological development.

Explicit and Implicit Demand



“Explicit components address the direct demand of the question, whereas implicit elements enhance continuity and flow in the answer.”

Illustration : Implicit and Explicit

जब पहले से ही अन्य उपग्रह नेविगेशन सिस्टम उपलब्ध हैं, तो NavIC की आवश्यकता क्यों है? (उत्तर 150 शब्दों में दीजिए)
What is the need for NavIC when existing satellite navigation systems are already available? (Answer in 150 words)

NavIC refers to a constellation of satellites $[7 = 3 + 4]$ that serves as a Regional Navigation System.

7 total $\rightarrow$ 3 in geostationary orbit
4 in geosynchronous orbit

Extent of coverage:

1500 km beyond India's borders

Need for NavIC

① Strategic security

India cannot be at mercy of GPS (USA) or Galileo (EU).

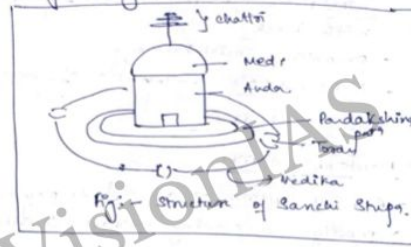
② Need for SARAR initiative

Security & growth for all in region for maritime domain awareness (MDA)



सांची स्तूप के ऐतिहासिक और स्थापत्य कला संबंधी महत्व का विवरण दीजिए। सांची स्तूप, यहाँ कीजिए कि इसने भारत में भविष्य की स्थापत्य कला को किस प्रकार प्रेरित किया है। (उत्तर 150 शब्दों में दीजिए)
Provide an account of the historical and architectural importance of the Sanchi Stupa. Also, discuss how it inspired the future architecture in India. (Answer in 150 words)

Sanchi Stupa is a buddhist monument built by Ashoka, revamped later by many rulers.



Historical and Architectural Importance

- 1) Built in around 260 BC
 $\rightarrow$ Cultural heritage of India
- 2) Represents Buddhism before it was divided in Mahayana and Theravada
- 3) Symbolism
 $\rightarrow$ Chhatra $\rightarrow$ 3 jewels of Stupa
 $\rightarrow$ Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha

Introduction



Introduction

The introduction should immediately establish context and show clarity of understanding of the question.

It may begin with a precise definition of a key term or concept used in the question.

Definitions help anchor the answer and signal conceptual clarity to the examiner.

Alternatively, the introduction can draw from recent developments, current affairs, or contemporary debates related to the topic.

Using recent context demonstrates relevance and awareness without drifting into unnecessary detail.

The introduction should be brief, focused, and should naturally lead into the body of the answer.

Illustration : Introduction

Trace the evolution of the press in India. Also, discuss the instrumental impact it had during various stages of the Indian freedom struggle despite the repressive policies of the British. (Answer in 250 words)

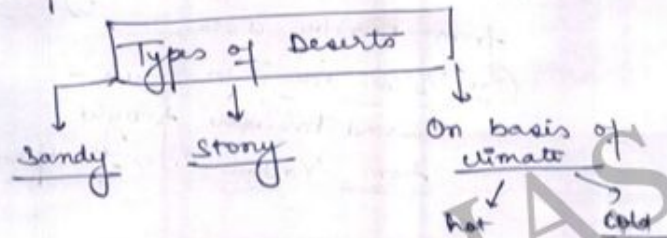
15

Tilak once said that evolution of press had significant impact on India's fight against British.

Highlighting the factors behind the formation of different types of deserts, give a brief account of the major landforms found in them. (Answer in 250 words)

15

Deserts are characterized by aridity conditions where wind plays the major role in erosion.



Conclusion



The conclusion should not repeat points already discussed in the body.

It should instead broaden the perspective and provide a sense of closure to the answer.

One effective approach is to refer to global best practices or international models relevant to the issue.

Another approach is to present a future-oriented or visionary outlook, aligned with long-term goals and sustainability.

Conclusions that reflect optimism, reform, or progress tend to leave a positive impression on the examiner.

Illustration : Conclusion

Around 30% land surface area is desert. In wake increasing anthropogenic activities, their encroachment into other areas is increasing. Thus, to stop this process of desertification initiatives like Green Wall of Sahel region is needed.

Thus there is need to learn from states like Kerala and abide by principle of Subsidiarity (2nd Arc) and empower PRIs.

Overall look of an Answer



Electric Mobility offers solutions to problems associated with climate change, growing fuel prices and urban transportation issues. Discuss in the context of India (250 words) (15 Marks)

20. Electric mobility offers solutions to the problems associated with climate change, growing fuel prices, and urban transportation issues. Discuss in the context of India. (250 words) 15

इलेक्ट्रिक मोबिलिटी जलवायु परिवर्तन, ईंधन की बढ़ती कीमतों और शहरी परिवहन के मुद्दों से जुड़ी समस्याओं का समाधान प्रदान करती है। भारत के संदर्भ में चर्चा कीजिए।

Fast Adoption & Manufacturing of

E-Vehicles (FAME) scheme of government aims to increase the production & use of electric vehicles.

• Electric mobility - a solution :-

① Climate change:-

(a) Reduced GHG emissions:- It eliminates hazardous emissions of NO_x , CO_x made by fossil fuels like petrol & diesel.

(b) Alternative to coal:- India's phasing out of coal can be helped replacing it with electric mobility solutions.

(c) Reduced global warming:- It can prevent

increase in temperature due to emissions by vehicles.

② Growing fuel prices:-

(a) Reduce India's import bill:- India's dependence on global oil resources can be reduced by moving to electric mobility.

(b) Accessibility improvement:- Electric mobility shall also allow lower class people to buy vehicles due to reduced dependence on fuel prices.

③ Urban transportation:-

(a) Reduced noise pollution:- Electric vehicles do not produce as much noise as petrol & diesel vehicles.

(b) Increased efficiency:- Of urban transportation due to electric vehicles. eg. Delhi's Electric Bus

• Persistent challenges with electric mobility

① Dependence on lithium:- India is dependent on China for Li batteries used in electric vehicles.

② Support infrastructure:- Charging stations, battery swap, etc. is still not available according to the demand.

③ High initial cost:- Initial cost of e-vehicles is as high as ₹1,00,000 for 2-wheelers making it unaffordable.

Thus, electric mobility should be supported with relevant infrastructure, public awareness & greater affordability to prove to be an effective solution.

Overall look of an Answer

16. Critical analysis how India's recent demographic dividend presents both opportunities and challenges for social justice. Suggest measures to leverage the second demographic dividend to create a more just and equitable society. (250 Words, 15 Marks)

India is set to have 16% of population as senior citizens by 2040 as projected by World Population prospects.

This presents unique set of opportunities and challenges as a result of second demographic dividend.

Opportunities of second demographic dividend

- ① Change of the experience of the generation in quinary sector
- ② Boost to GDP of India from both young population and older population
- ③ Aged provides for greater population consumption expenditure and potential for growth

- ④ Social benefits: providing of primary socialization for young generation
- ⑤ Healthy second demographic dividend
Ensure less health expenditure for government → divert to development

- ⑥ Development of silver economy and related industries

Challenges of second demographic dividend

- ① Dependency ratio of the population will increase
- ② Increasing non-communicable diseases incidence (cardiovascular diseases & CKN syndrome)
- ③ Mental health issues surrounding senior citizens (due to generation gap)
- ④ Health facilities deficit
Only 1.5% of GDP is spent on health now

- ① Low penetration of insurance, less insurance density & penetration
- ② Digital inclusion is far from adequate
- ③ Feminization of old age also cause of concern

Strategies for reaping benefits of second demographic dividend

- ① Healthy ageing norms by WHO
- ② Lot of opportunities using portals like SACRED
- ③ Increasing maintenance under Maintenance to senior citizen Act
- ④ Digital inclusion inclusion PMG DISHA
- ⑤ Rehabilitation and palliative health care system boosted
- ⑥ Investment in health to boost to 2% of GDP (National Health Policy)
- ⑦ Care homes taboo being tackled by awareness

Senior citizens must be viewed as productive assets and mainstreamed rather than being put on edges.



Thank you

**“Big changes come from
hundreds of tiny steps”**